

?? Did You Know? The London-based hedge fund Man AHL, which manages over \$11.3 billion in assets, initially coded its trading systems in a different programming language. In 2015, they gradually migrated to Python. Within two years, their development speed had doubled, and they were able to implement trading strategies approximately twice as quickly as before. The simplicity of Python's variable system and overall syntax was cited as a major factor in this productivity boost.

Variable Naming Rules

While Python gives you freedom in naming variables, there are some important rules and conventions to follow:

1.
Names must start with a letter or underscore: price or `_price` are valid, but `2price` is not
2.
The rest of the name can contain letters, numbers, and underscores: `stock_price_2` is valid
3.
Names are case-sensitive: price and Price are different variables
4.
Avoid Python's reserved keywords: Words like if, for, and while have special meanings in Python

Following these conventions makes your code more readable and professional:

```
1. # Good variable names
2. stock_price = 142.58
3. apple_volume = 32500000
4. is_market_open = True
5.
6. # Poor variable names (avoid these)
7. sp = 142.58 # Too vague
8. a = 32500000 # Meaningless
9. x = True # Unclear purpose
```